

Expressions & Equations

Order of operations & unknowns

Order of Operations

1

Grouping symbols

Do what's inside () first.

2

Multiply or divide

Do these next, from left to right.

3

Add or subtract

Do these last, from left to right.

Example

$$2 \times (3 + 4)$$

$$= 2 \times 7$$

$$= 14$$

Equations with Unknowns

A letter or box can stand for a missing number. You can solve for the unknown.

Example

$$5 + \square = 12$$

$$\square = 7$$



A letter or box represents a number we don't know.



Solve the equation to find the missing number.



Do the parentheses first; a letter or box stands for a missing number.

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